AESTHETIC NURSING
POLICY & PROCEDURES, INC.

FREE RESOURCE · COMPLIANCE READINESS

Med Spa Compliance Readiness Checklist

A practical self-check for med spa owners, medical directors and aesthetic RNs, NPs and PAs. Use it to find documentation, oversight and policy gaps before a complaint, inspection or records request does.

28
checkpoints across 8 areas of your practice

22 of 32
Board accusations reviewed cited missing or insufficient standardized procedures

15 min
to complete with your medical director or practice lead

Cindi Vokey, BSN, RN, LNC · 27+ Years Nursing · Aesthetics Since 2007 · CA BRN-Approved CE Provider #18009

Education only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by state. Statistics are from Cindi's 2026 review of 32 publicly filed licensing Board accusations related to aesthetics.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Could you prove it today?

Most practices don't discover a gap until someone asks for the records. By then, the documents either exist or they don't. In Cindi's review of 32 aesthetic Board accusations, only 7 involved documented patient harm. Most turned on documentation: standardized procedures, good faith exams and physician oversight.

1 · Check honestly

Mark "In Place" only if the document exists, is current and you could hand it over today.

2 · Do it together

Complete it with your medical director or practice lead, not alone.

3 · Fix in order

Start with Sections 1 and 2. They were the most common gaps in the accusations reviewed.

01 Standardized Procedures & Policies

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Written standardized procedures or protocols exist for every treatment we offer, meet our state's criteria, and are signed by the medical director.	☐	☐
Our P&Ps were written for our state and scope, not adapted from a generic or association template. Generic "all 50 states" sets often miss state-specific requirements.	☐	☐
Every policy shows an effective date, a revision history and the signatures of the medical director and providers.	☐	☐
Policies are reviewed at least once a year and updated when services, providers, products or rules change.	☐	☐

Why it matters: 22 of the 32 accusations reviewed cited missing or insufficient standardized procedures.

02 Good Faith Exam & Medical Oversight

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Every patient has a documented good faith exam by an appropriately licensed provider before treatment begins.	☐	☐
Remote or telehealth exams include a documented treatment plan and communication with the treating nurse.	☐	☐
Our medical director agreement defines supervision duties, availability and chart review, and chart reviews are logged.	☐	☐
Our medical director is trained in, and available for, the treatments being supervised.	☐	☐

Why it matters: lack of physician oversight and missing or third-party good faith exams were among the top three gaps.

03 Patient Records & Consent

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Every chart includes medical history, treatment-specific consent, product, dose, injection sites and the correct lot number.	☐	☐
Consent forms are specific to each treatment and are updated when product labeling or risks change.	☐	☐
Aftercare instructions given to each patient are documented in the chart.	☐	☐
Before-and-after photos and patient records are stored and shared with HIPAA safeguards.	☐	☐

04 Treatments, Devices & Products

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Laser and energy device protocols require and document test spots and device settings.	☐	☐
All products are FDA-approved where required and purchased through a legitimate U.S. supply chain, under our own license.	☐	☐
A lot-tracking log is kept and matches what is recorded in each chart.	☐	☐
Product storage, temperature and expiration checks are documented.	☐	☐

05 Team, Training & Scope

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Every provider has signed competencies for each treatment they perform.	☐	☐
No task is delegated to anyone without the license and training to perform it.	☐	☐
Current licenses, certifications and CE records are on file for every provider, with renewal dates tracked.	☐	☐

06 Adverse Events & Emergencies

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Adverse events trigger a written protocol, including physician notification, follow-up and documentation.	☐	☐
Emergency supplies required by our protocols are on site, checked and logged, and the team knows how to use them.	☐	☐
Staff know who to call, and how quickly, when a complication happens after hours.	☐	☐

07 Business Structure & Marketing

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
Our corporate structure and ownership have been reviewed against our state's rules. Some states limit who may own a medical practice. Confirm with a healthcare attorney.	☐	☐
Our website and social media claims have been reviewed for advertising compliance.	☐	☐
Any required business permits or fictitious name filings are current.	☐	☐

08 Records-Request Readiness

CHECKPOINT	IN PLACE	NEEDS WORK
If the Board requested our P&Ps today, we could send them within 24 hours.	☐	☐
At least one person knows where every policy, agreement, competency and log is kept.	☐	☐
Our team can show that written procedures are actually followed, not just filed.	☐	☐

YOUR RESULTS

25–28 In Place
Strong foundation. Schedule your annual review and keep logs current.

18–24 In Place
Targeted gaps. Fix Sections 1 and 2 first, then work down the list.

17 or Fewer
Start with an assessment or a state-specific manual before adding services.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Binder Blueprint
Free. See what your binder needs for your state and treatment menu in about 90 seconds.
Try the Binder Blueprint →

Custom Manual
State-specific policies with your practice name and providers, reviewed by Cindi.
Start the Manual Builder →

Book a Free Consult
30 minutes with Cindi to walk through your results and a written next step.
Book Your Free Consult →

Questions About Your Results?

Email Cindi at info@aestheticnursingpnp.com

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This checklist is for education and self-assessment only. It is not legal advice and does not establish that a practice meets any law, regulation or Board requirement. Scope of practice, supervision, good faith exam, ownership and documentation rules vary by state and change over time. Review your results with your medical director and, where needed, a healthcare attorney. Aesthetic Nursing Policy & Procedures, Inc. provides consulting and education services and is not a law firm. © 2026 Aesthetic Nursing Policy & Procedures, Inc.